

CASE ID: 202208710713

EPISODE NAME: China restricts Taiwanese imports Nancy Pelosi

2022/08/02 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Contain Political Influence (1)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Narrative:

On 2022/08/02, Beijing suddenly suspended customs registrations for 2,066 of roughly 3,200 Taiwanese food exporters, preventing them from selling into the Chinese market.¹ The decision served as a warning of further sanctions to come after US Speaker of the House Nancy Pelosi visited the island on 2022/08/02.² China did not threaten Taiwan with economic sanctions before the visit, and claimed that the measures were to protect food safety standards.³

In a further escalation, China banned exports of natural sand from China to Taiwan on 2022/08/03.⁴ Also on 2022/08/03 China halted imports of citrus fruit, chilled white striped hairtail, and frozen horse mackerel.⁵ Again, China claimed the actions were taken for procedural reasons unrelated to political tensions between Beijing and Taipei.⁶

Finally, in addition to trade restrictions, China's state news agency announced on 2022/08/03 that Chinese entities were prohibited from cooperation or financial dealings with the Taiwan Foundation for Democracy and the Taiwan Foreign Ministry's International Cooperation and Development Fund.⁷ Four Taiwanese companies would also no longer be allowed to enter China.⁸

Outside of economic coercion, the People's Liberation Army escalated military activity near the island between 2022/08/03 and 2022/08/08.⁹

¹ Coyne, Andy. "China blocks food imports from Taiwan following Pelosi visit." *JustFood*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.just-food.com/news/china-blocks-food-imports-from-taiwan-following-pelosi-visit/?cf-view>

² "Factbox: Sanctions China has imposed on Taiwan over Pelosi visit." *Reuters*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/economic-sanctions-china-has-imposed-taiwan-over-pelosi-visit-2022-08-03/>

³ "China restricts trade with Taiwan amid tensions over Pelosi trip." *Al Jazeera*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/2022/8/3/china-halts-sand-exports-to-taiwan-amid-tension-over-pelosi-trip>

⁴ "Factbox: Sanctions China has imposed on Taiwan over Pelosi visit." *Reuters*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/economic-sanctions-china-has-imposed-taiwan-over-pelosi-visit-2022-08-03/>

⁵ "Factbox: Sanctions China has imposed on Taiwan over Pelosi visit." *Reuters*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/economic-sanctions-china-has-imposed-taiwan-over-pelosi-visit-2022-08-03/>

⁶ *Ibid.*

⁷ "Factbox: Sanctions China has imposed on Taiwan over Pelosi visit." *Reuters*, 3 Aug. 2022. <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/economic-sanctions-china-has-imposed-taiwan-over-pelosi-visit-2022-08-03/>

⁸ *Ibid.*

⁹ Klare, Michael T. "China Reacts Aggressively to Pelosi's Taiwan Visit." *Arms Control Association*, 1 Sep. 2022. <https://www.armscontrol.org/act/2022-09/news/china-reacts-aggressively-pelosis-taiwan-visit>

Most of the sanctions are still in effect. However, the aquaculture product restrictions were lifted on 2023/03/17, after China phased out COVID-era safety requirements.¹⁰ China also lifted restrictions on citrus fruit, specifically pomelos, on 2024/09/03.¹¹ Commentary at the time suggested that Beijing eased the bans in an attempt to persuade Taiwanese voters that the Kuomintang (KMT), which is more compliant with Chinese political interests than their rivals the Democratic Progressive Party, would provide economic security by cooperating with China.¹² China's Taiwan Affairs Office spokesperson credited the lifting of the citrus restrictions to KMT leader Fu Kun-chi's efforts to reopen the market.¹³

¹⁰ "China lifts ban on chilled beltfish, horse mackerel." Taipei Times, 17 March 2023.

<https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/taiwan/archives/2023/03/17/2003796253>

¹¹ Jennings, Ralph. "Mainland China resumes Taiwanese pomelo imports, ending 2-year ban." *South China Morning Post*, 3 Sep. 2024.

<https://www.scmp.com/economy/article/3277040/mainland-china-resumes-taiwanese-pomelo-imports-ending-2-year-ban>

¹² Hioe, Brian. "China Lifts Pomelo Ban to Influence Taiwan Economically." *New Bloom*, 11 Sep. 2024.

<https://newbloommag.net/2024/09/11/pomelo-ban-lift/>

¹³ *Ibid.*